Dear Halden Pay Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Senior Data Engineer – Data Platform position. With nine years of experience building and operating production data platforms across payments, logistics and retail, I have worked on the kinds of reliable, reusable systems that data, product and finance teams depend on.

At Lukovac Freight Hub, I own the ingestion and orchestration layer of a platform with approximately 140 Airflow DAGs, and migrated more than 300 stored procedures into dbt models. That work reduced nightly warehouse build time from 5 hours 10 minutes to 1 hour 35 minutes. I have also improved Snowflake warehouse efficiency, introduced JSON Schema data contracts and CI checks, and built a Kafka-based pipeline processing around 30 million events per day. These projects have strengthened my approach to owning and operating a production data platform: make systems dependable, simplify where possible, and work with teams to prevent issues at their source.

Earlier, at Kovalent Pay, I built PySpark jobs on AWS EMR to reconcile approximately 1.2 TB of settlement data daily, designed a Redshift dimensional data warehouse using dimensional modelling for finance and risk, and introduced data quality checks for critical finance tables. Across these roles, I have used advanced Python and SQL for large-scale data processing and query and transformation performance optimisation, including reducing a production warehouse build from 5 hours 10 minutes to 1 hour 35 minutes. My hands-on experience with AWS, Snowflake, Airflow, dbt, Python and SQL provides a strong foundation for working with Halden Pay's cloud data platform. I also contribute to open-source projects, including merged fixes and tests for an Airflow provider, mentor engineers, and share data-engineering practices through community teaching—experiences that fit well with your emphasis on collaboration, ownership and learning.

I work professionally in English and enjoy sharing context across teams, mentoring colleagues, and turning operational lessons into reusable platform practices.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my experience building scalable data platforms and improving their reliability could contribute to Halden Pay's Data Platform team.

Kind regards,
Lena Varga-Holm